

Britton, Chris

From: DSHS's Economic Services Administration <ESAWA@public.govdelivery.com>
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To: Britton, Chris
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Economic Services Administration

Information Technology Solutions

Summer 2018 – ESAR Project Update



ESAR Vision: *“Improved operations through modernized infrastructure.”*

What is ESAR?

The [Eligibility System and ACES Remediation \(ESAR\) project](#) is the effort to modernize the Automated Client Eligibility System (ACES) and meet the Center for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) standards and conditions. ACES is an integrated complex of applications used by DSHS field staff as a tool for determining eligibility, issuing benefits, and sharing data between agencies.

Why is the ESAR project important?

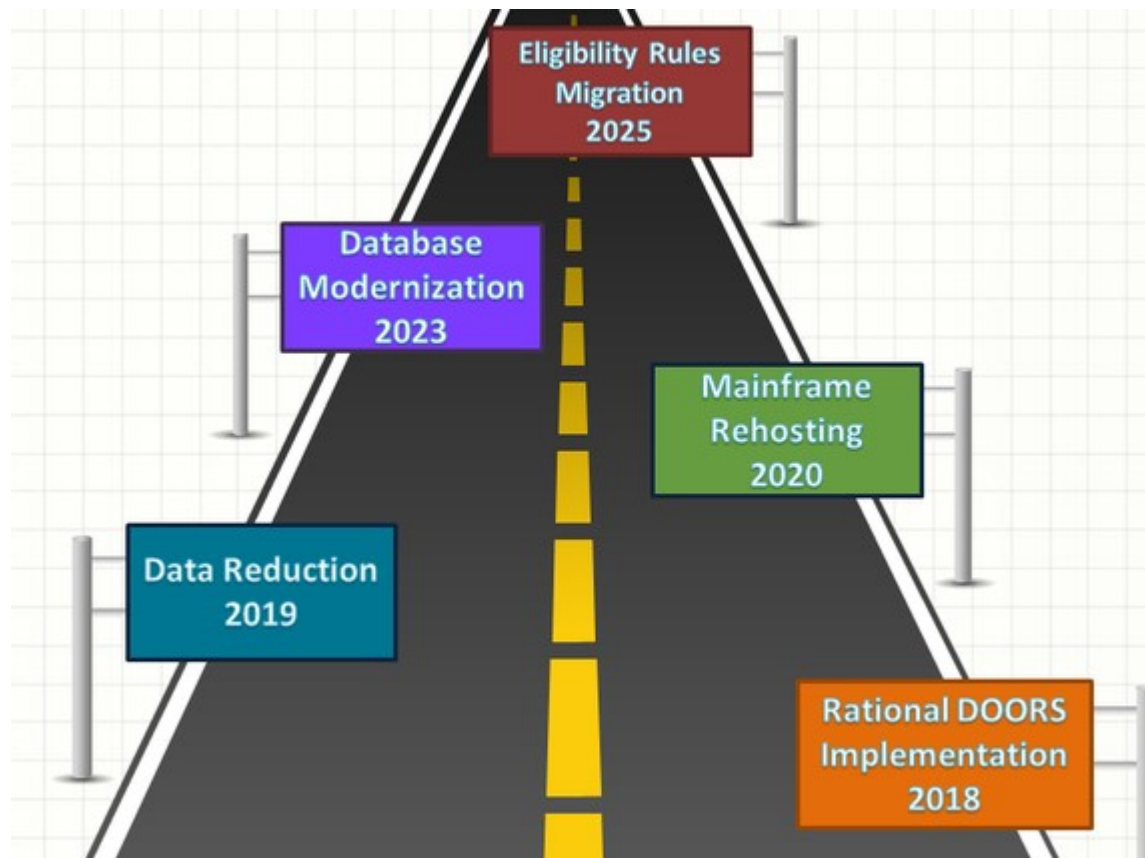
The ACES complex is a major part of our aging infrastructure that includes multiple technologies including a legacy mainframe system that must be maintained and eventually replaced with a modern distributed environment.

Many organizations and individuals depend on the current system to support eligibility, enrollment, payments, service delivery and data analysis. In order for us to continue delivering these services, the infrastructure must be maintained or it will eventually fail, jeopardizing our ability to provide critical services to millions of clients across the state.

Customers, staff and partners expect flexibility, adaptability, accessibility, and responsiveness as business needs change. As a state agency, we are accountable to these stakeholders to ensure these systems are operating properly and efficiently.

The ESAR project will provide a better, more efficient system that will offer greater flexibility over the long term for users, our partners, and ultimately our clients.

ESAR Project Overview



The ESAR project comprises five core tracks. These tracks encompass the overall scope of the ESAR Project, and include the following:

1. Rational DOORS Next Generation (RDNG)

Objective: Create reusable requirements with improved traceability.

Upon completion in June 2018, this project track will implement a requirements management tool called Rational DOORS Next Generation (RDNG), which provides the opportunity to refine requirements processes and definitions as well as offer a path to traceability from design to testing. Learn more about RDNG at [ESAR's information page](#).

2. Data Reduction

Objective: Minimize potential security exposure through reduction of data and reports inventory.

With work currently underway and on schedule for completion in early 2019, this project track aims to improve batch processing times by reducing the number of obsolete reports and unused or dormant ACES data. In addition, this track is working to define the data retention policies for archiving/purging ACES live data, which must be done in advance of

any future database conversions or migrations. Learn more about Data Reduction. Learn more about Data Reduction at [ESAR's information page](#).

3. Mainframe Rehosting

Objective: Make the system more adaptable to future modernization by reducing our dependency on legacy mainframe technologies.

With a scheduled completion of August 2020, rehosting the ACES Complex of applications to a modern open-system architecture (i.e., rehosting from the mainframe to an open distributed system environment) will improve operational efficiency and reduce maintenance and operations costs. This will also reduce the data duplication problems. Learn more about Mainframe Rehosting at [ESAR's information page](#).

4. Database Modernization

Objective: Replace the legacy database with a modern database.

With completion scheduled for May 2023, the objective of this track is to improve operational efficiency by providing a new relational database. Learn more about Database Modernization at [ESAR's information page](#).

5. Eligibility Rules Migration (ERM)

Objective: Bringing all eligibility rules under one common, unified system.

Scheduled for completion in early 2025, the ERM project will modernize ACES by providing a single, integrated business rules management system (BRMS) that includes all eligibility decisions, allowing for faster and more accurate changes to the system. Learn more about ERM at [ESAR's information page](#).

ESAR successes

Data Reduction Team Does Just That!

The Data Reduction team successfully implemented the October 2017 and January 2018 releases. They accomplished the following work:

- 89 unused reports were eliminated.
- 646 components were archived.
- 380 million database calls were eliminated.
- Nine hours of processing time reduced from the Month Begin batch cycle.
- Three unused legacy databases were removed.
- 28 million records were deleted.
- 526 datasets were removed.

Rational DOORS Next Generation (RDNG) Team Opens New Doors!

The RDNG Team recognized the importance of having the right people from key areas within the organization play the important role of training their peers. Subject Matter Experts, Application Development Management, Architecture, Business Analysts, Customer Support and testing teams attended a four-day session that included two days of classroom



and concept-based knowledge transfer and two days of hands-on exercises and instruction using the new requirements management tool. Upon completing their sessions, the team began working with their teams to conduct more focused knowledge transfer sessions.

Meet the ESAR project team

The ESAR project team gathers personnel with the necessary expertise from a diverse array of backgrounds, including technicians, developers, consultants and project managers.

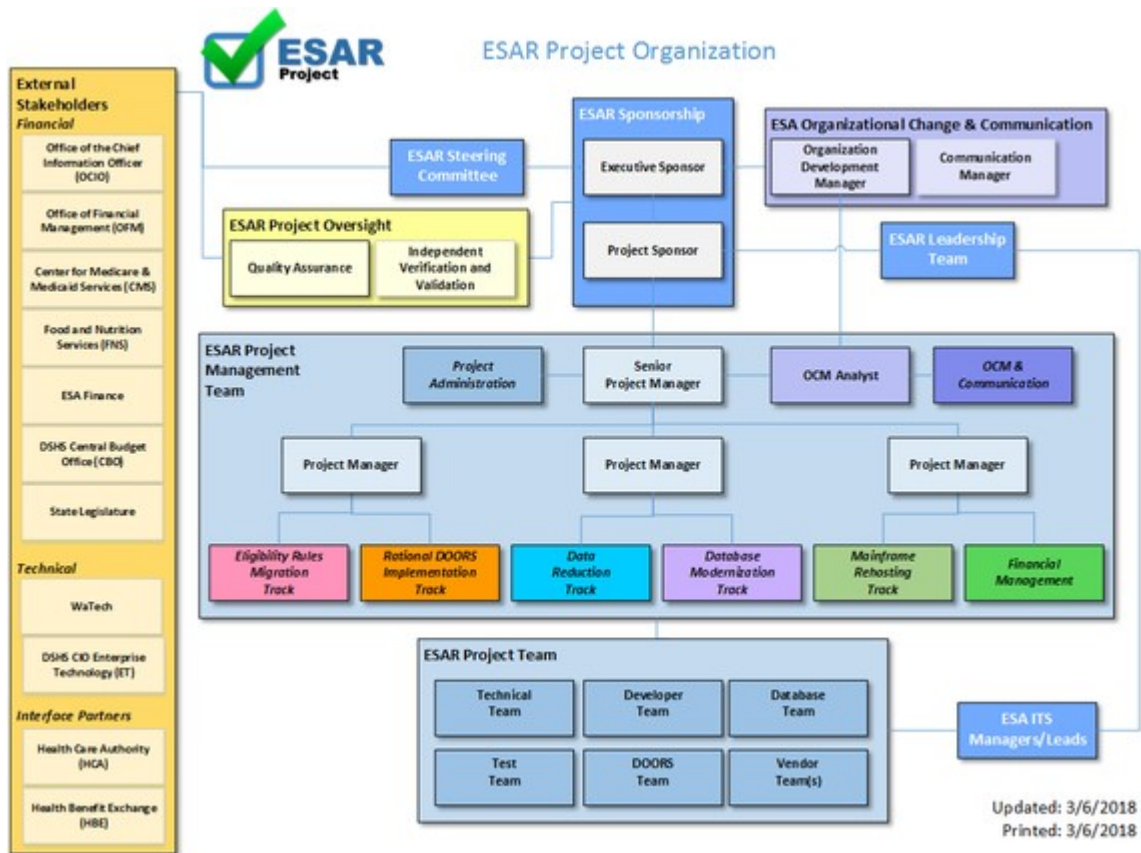
While there are many state and contract staff working on ESAR to some extent, the teams listed here represent staff that are currently dedicated 100 percent to the project.

Technical staff

- David Greggs, DOORS Consultant
- Rajesh Gujarati, Database Architect/Administrator
- Charice Thomas, Database Modeler
- Charu Deshpande, Senior Developer
- Nikhil Dharmadhikari, Lead Developer
- Cinta Wanders, Senior Developer
- Ty Merbach, Business Analyst
- Colleen Smith, Test Lead

Project Management Team

- Jeff Closson, Senior Project Manager
- Reddy Varakantham, Project Manager
- Setty Duddu, Project Manager
- Chris Cognasso, Project Manager
- Jody Guy, Organizational Change Management Specialist



People Side of Change: Jody Guy

Please join us in welcoming Jody Guy to the OAS team!

Jody joined the team in mid-March as our new Organizational Change Management (OCM) Specialist. She will be specifically supporting all of the ESAR OCM needs! Jody comes to us with 10-plus years of experience in the public sector, with a focus on change management, training, communications, and process improvement.

Please contact Senior Organizational Development Manager Jen McCoy for any questions at BeckeJA@dshs.wa.gov or (360) 725-4780.



Do you have questions or comments about ESAR?

Please contact Jeff Closson, Senior ESAR Project Manager
 Email: clossjx@dshs.wa.gov
 Phone: 360-725-4602

Or visit our ESAR Project page: <https://its.esa.dshs.wa.lcl/esar>

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